Sign in to Google Drive for desktop

Digital Technologies · School computers

You will

- sign in to Google Drive for desktop with your school account
- find your files in File Explorer at `Google Drive (G:)` › `My Drive`

You need

- a school computer
- your school Google account and password

Before you start

- On your own computer? Install Google Drive for desktop first, then come back to this guide.
- Already see Google Drive (G:) in File Explorer? You're already signed in. Skip to the last step to check.

 Click here  Look here

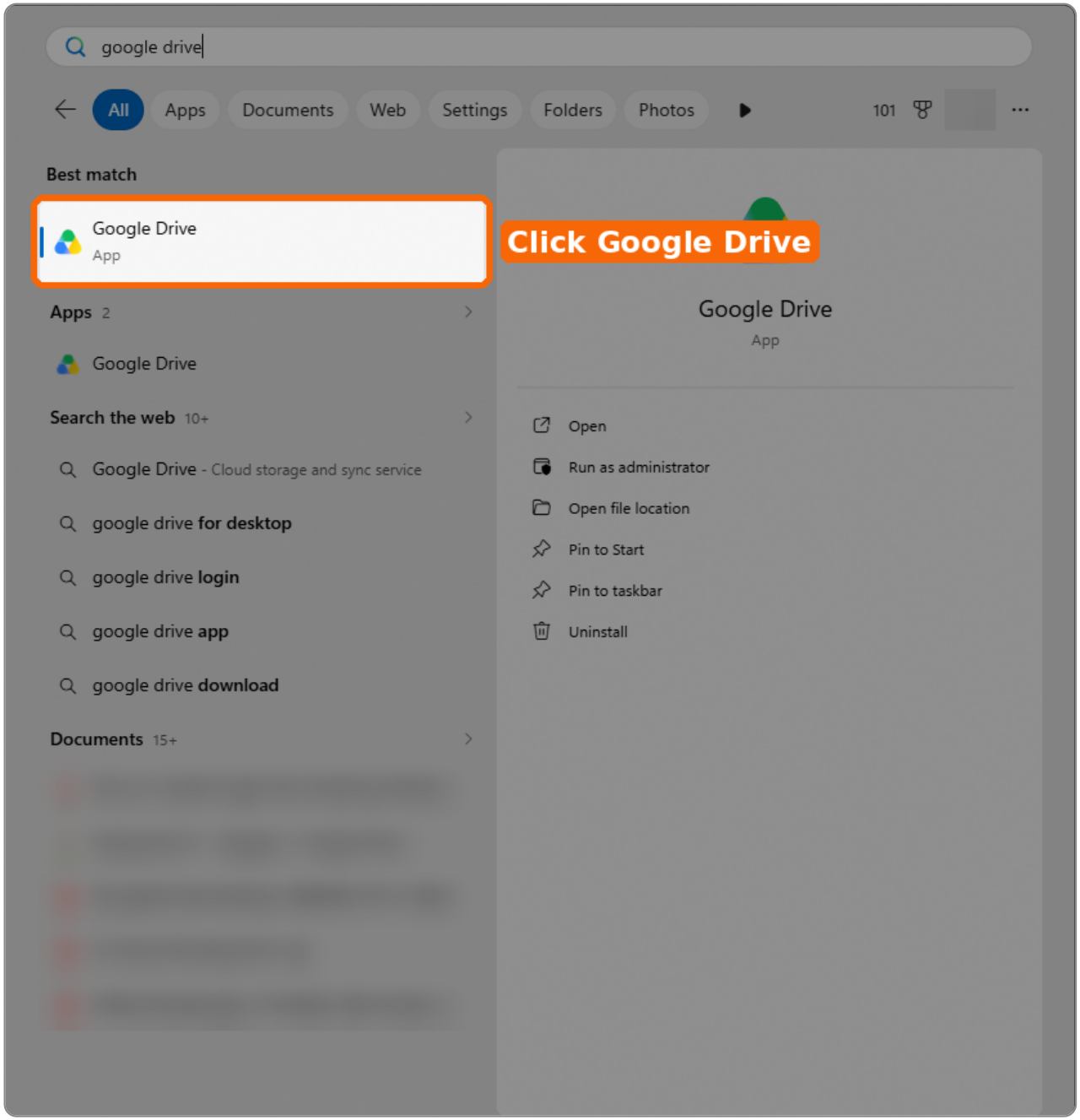
1

Windows › Start menu

Click **Start**.

Type `google drive`.

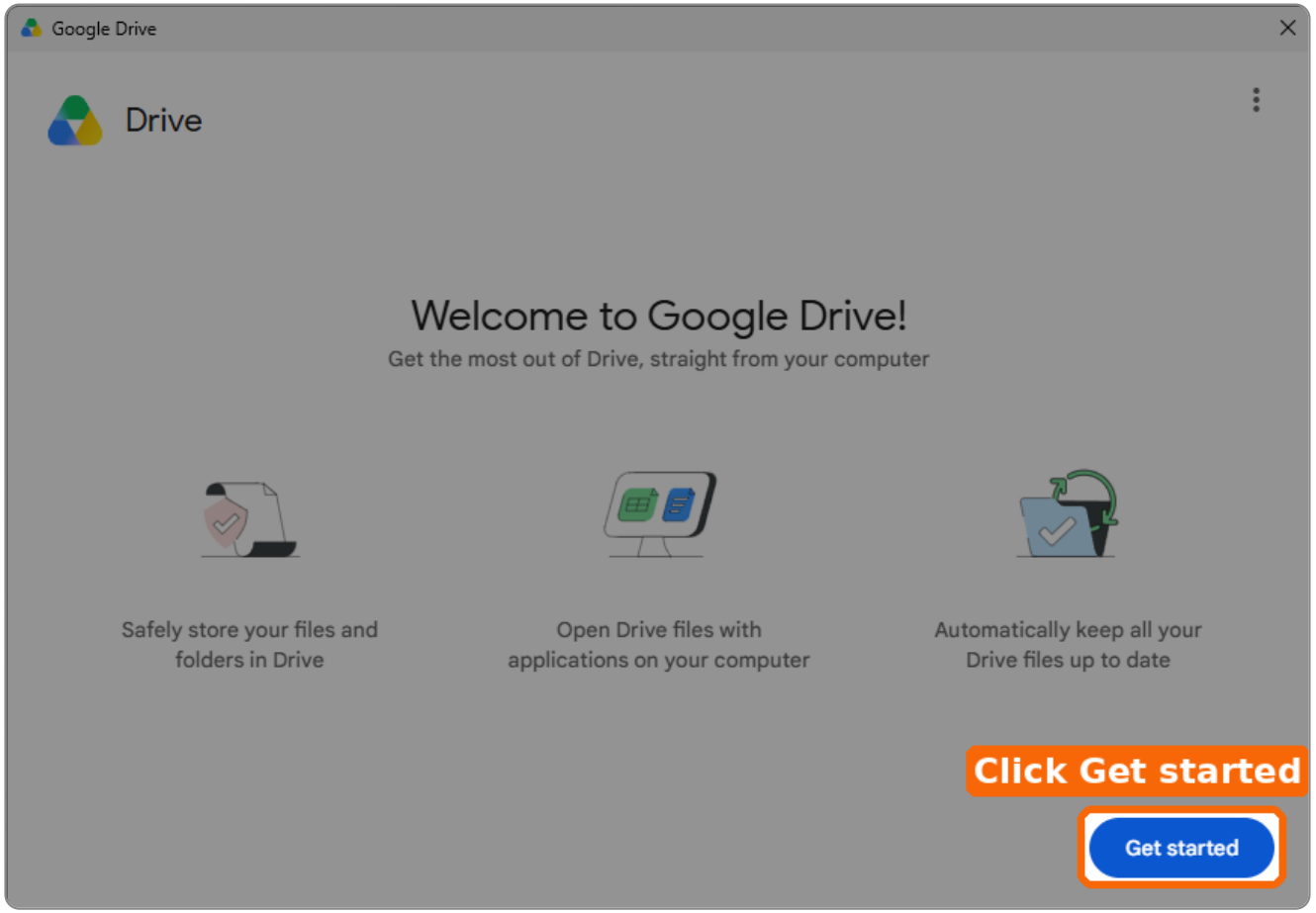
Click **Google Drive** under **Best match**.



2

Google Drive › Welcome

Click **Get started**.

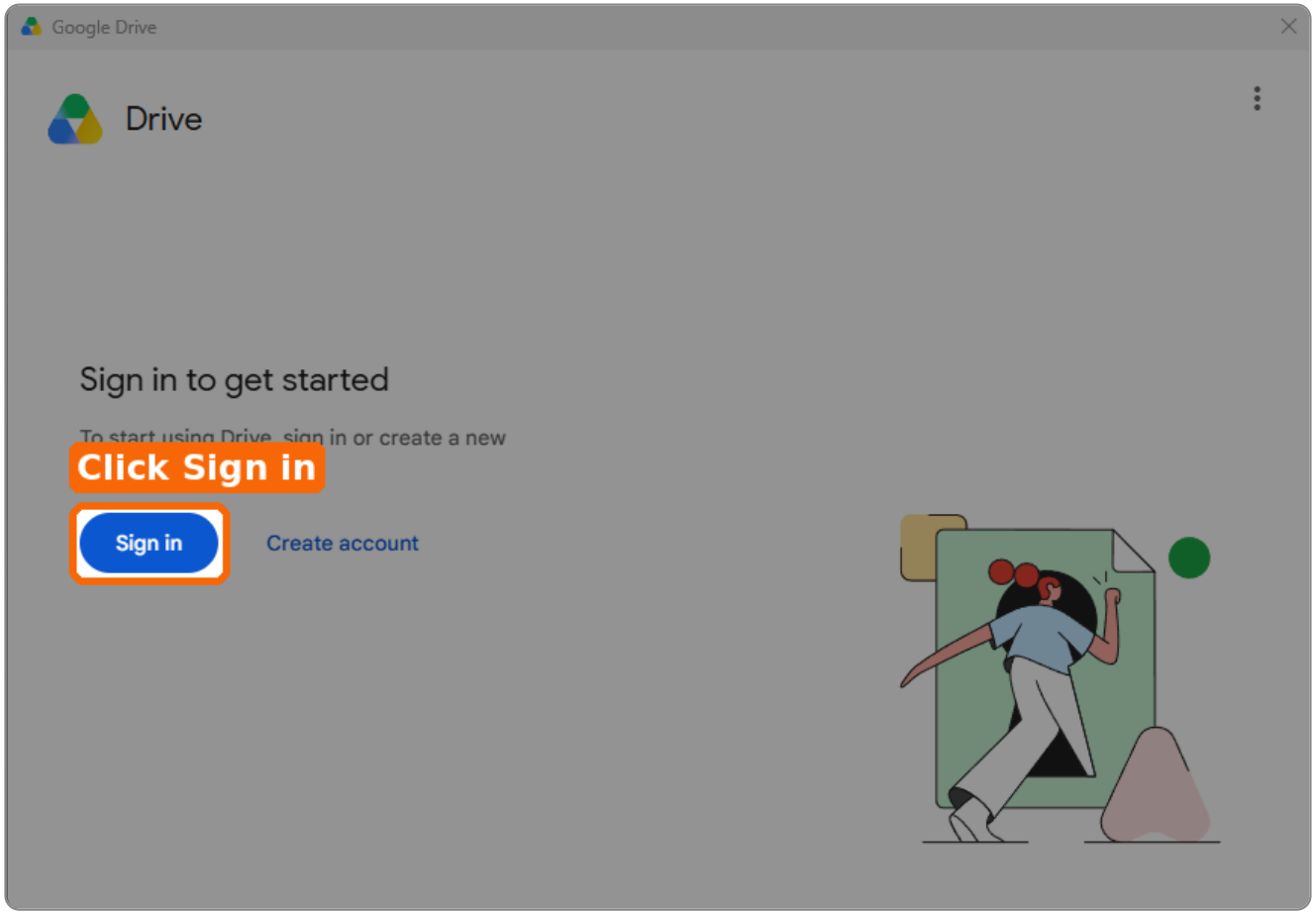


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Google Drive › Sign in

Click **Sign in**.

> **Check:** Chrome opens a sign-in page.

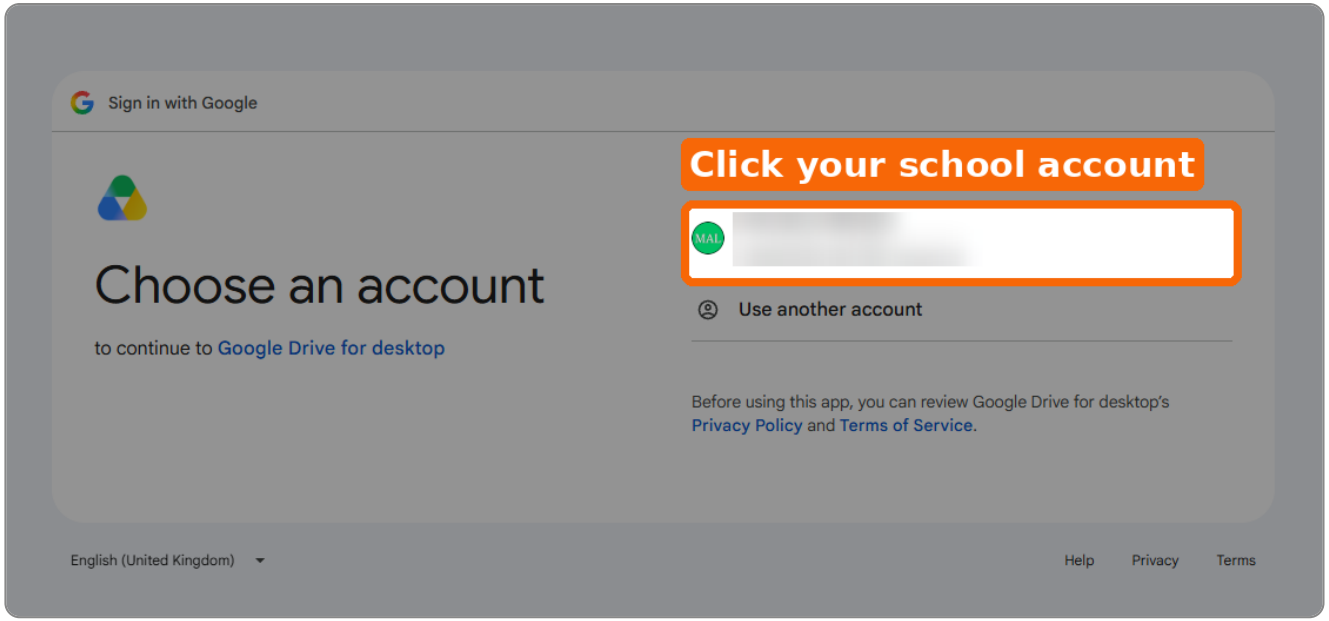


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Chrome › Choose an account

Click your school account.

If something goes wrong
Your school account isn't there: click **Use another account** and sign in with your school email and password.

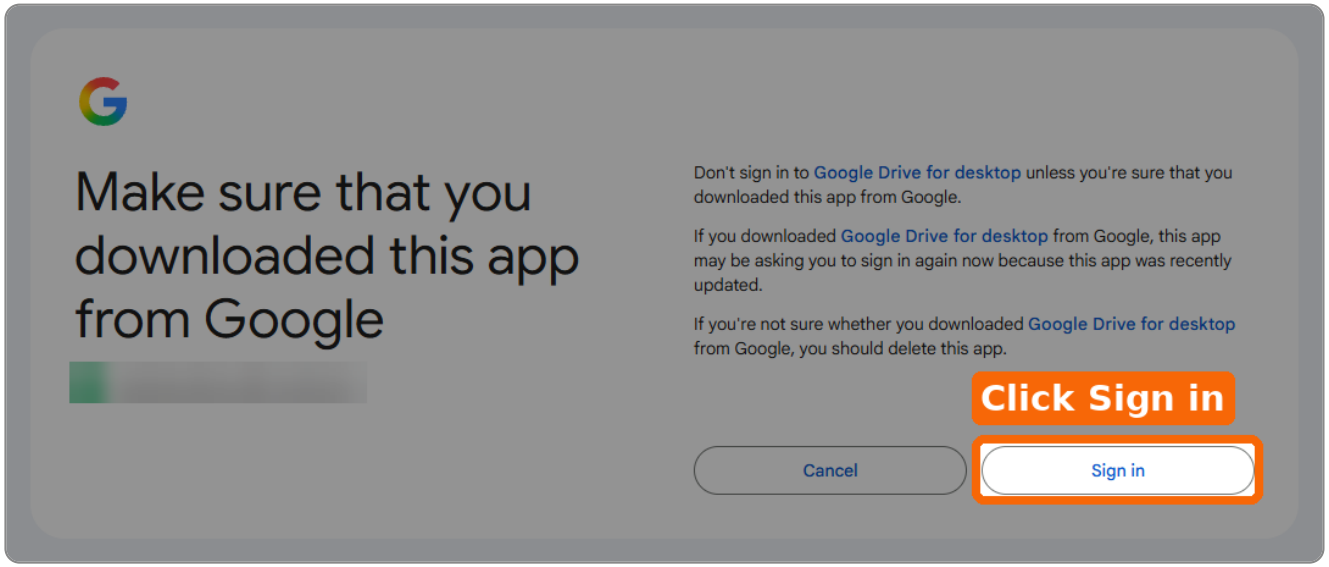


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Chrome › Make sure that you downloaded this app

Click **Sign in**.

This page checks that the app came from Google. On school computers, it did.



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Chrome › Success!

Close this tab.

Go back to the Google Drive window.

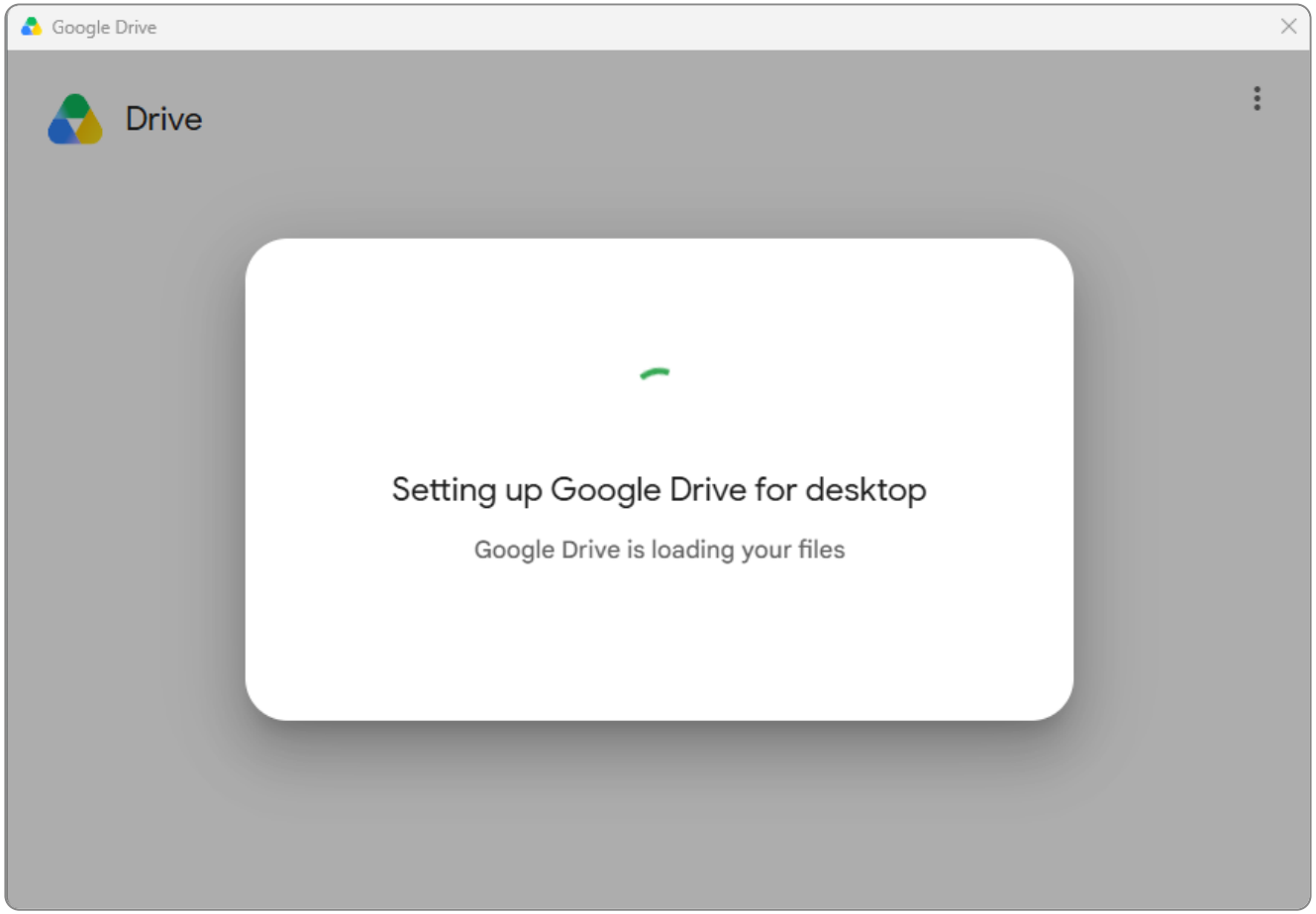
> **Check:** the page says **You've signed in to Google Drive**.



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Google Drive › Setting up

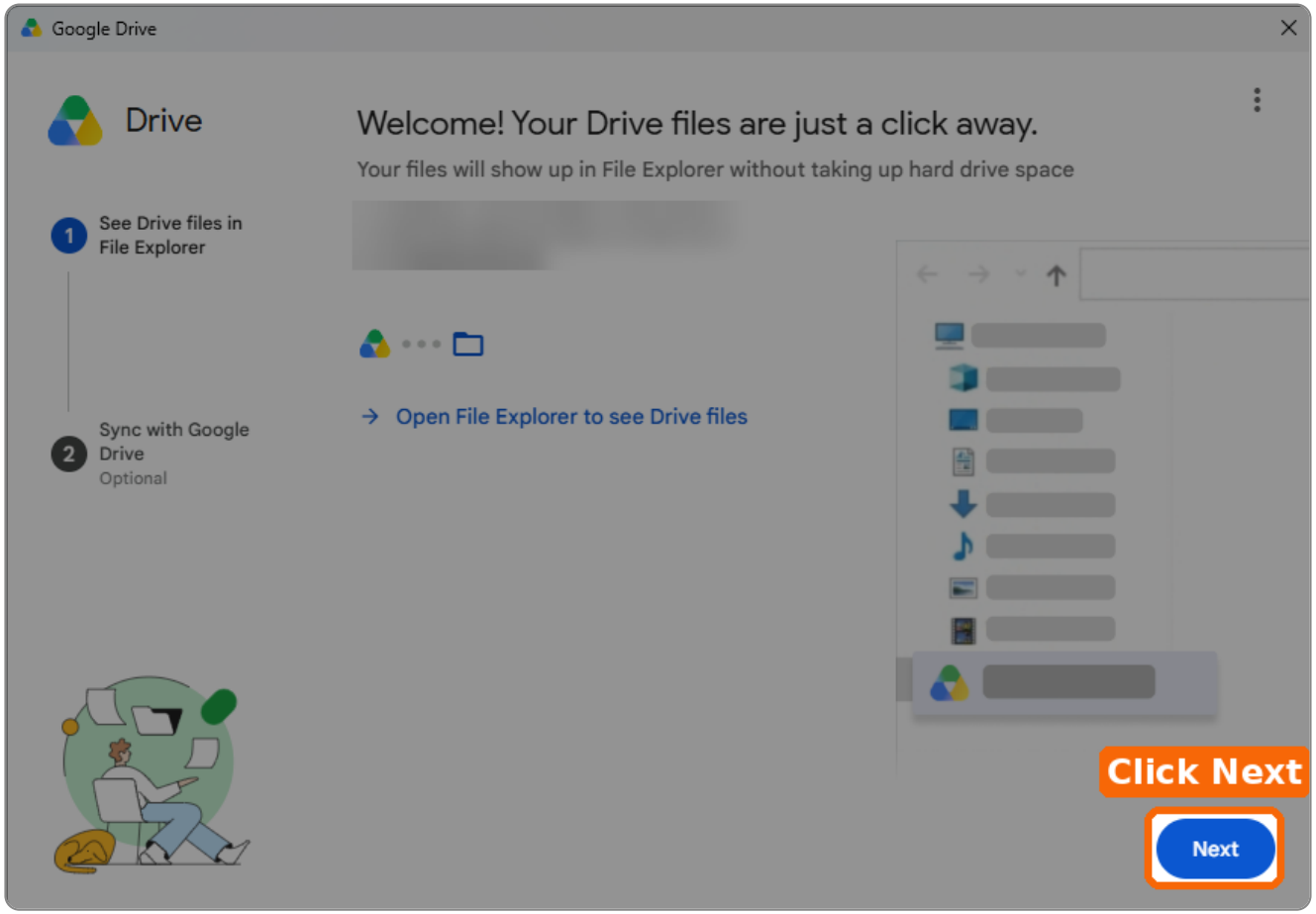
Wait while Google Drive loads your files.



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Google Drive › Welcome!

Click **Next**.

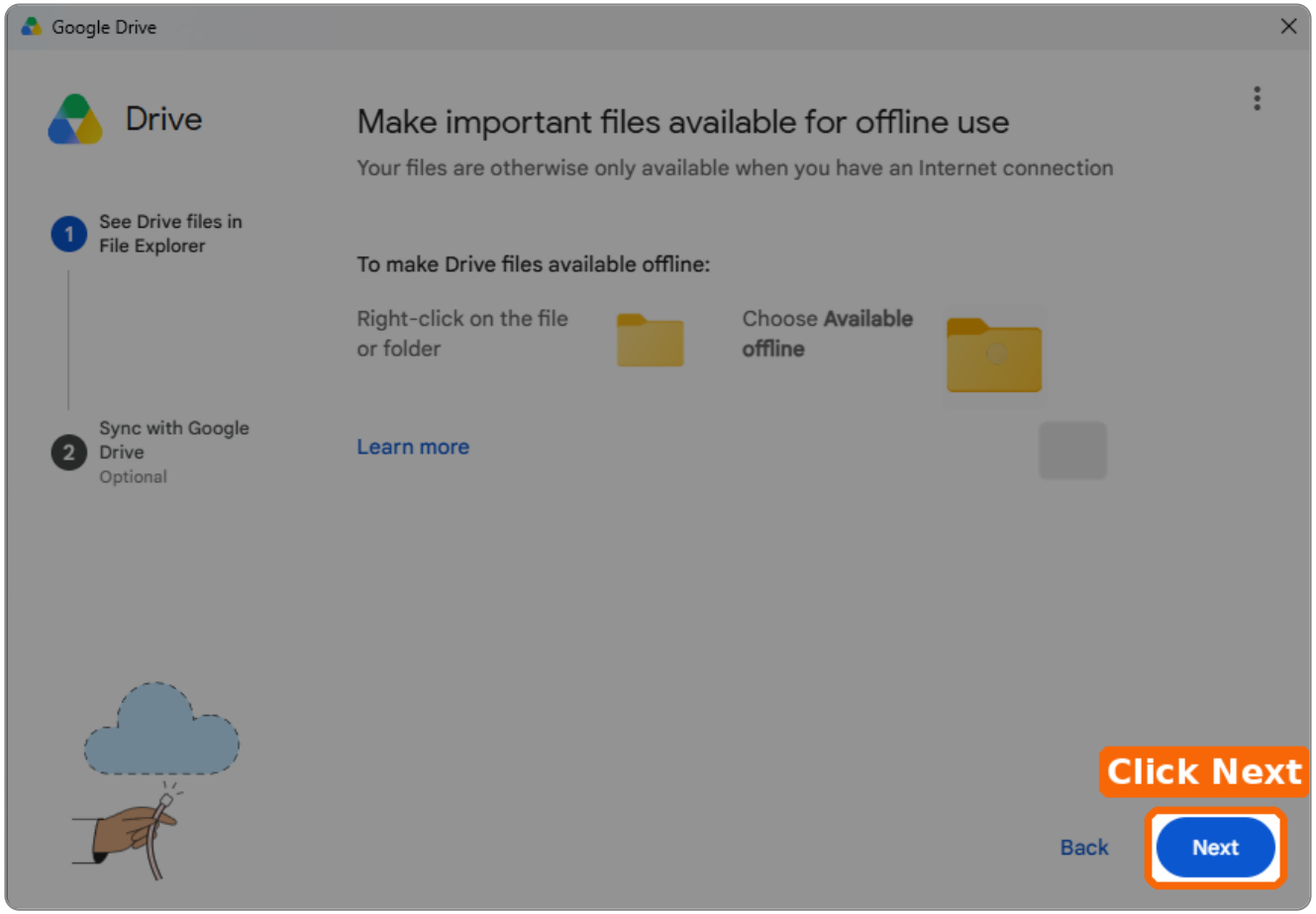


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Google Drive › Offline files

Click **Next**.

You don't need offline files at school.



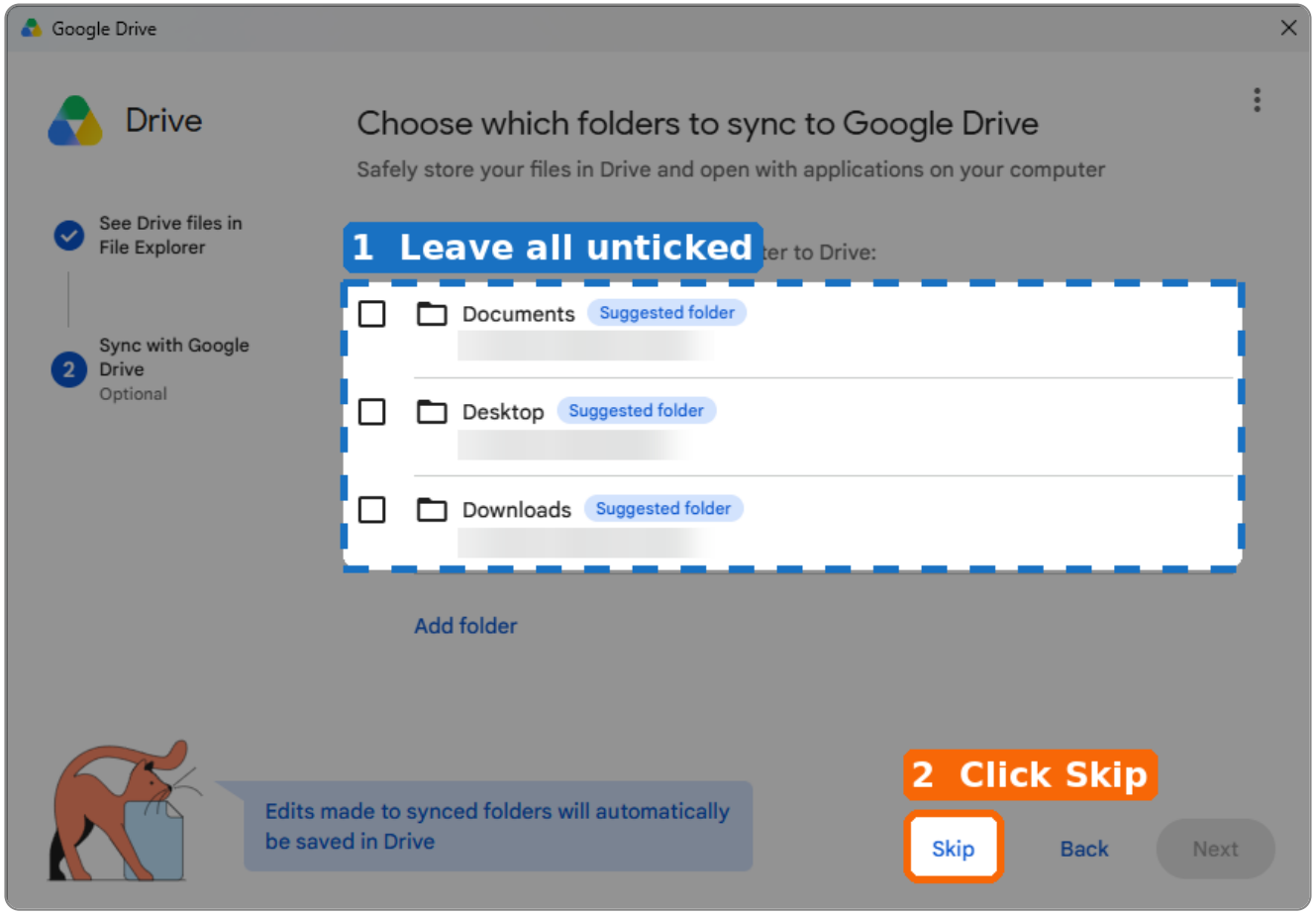
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Google Drive › Choose folders to sync

Leave every box unticked.

Click **Skip**.

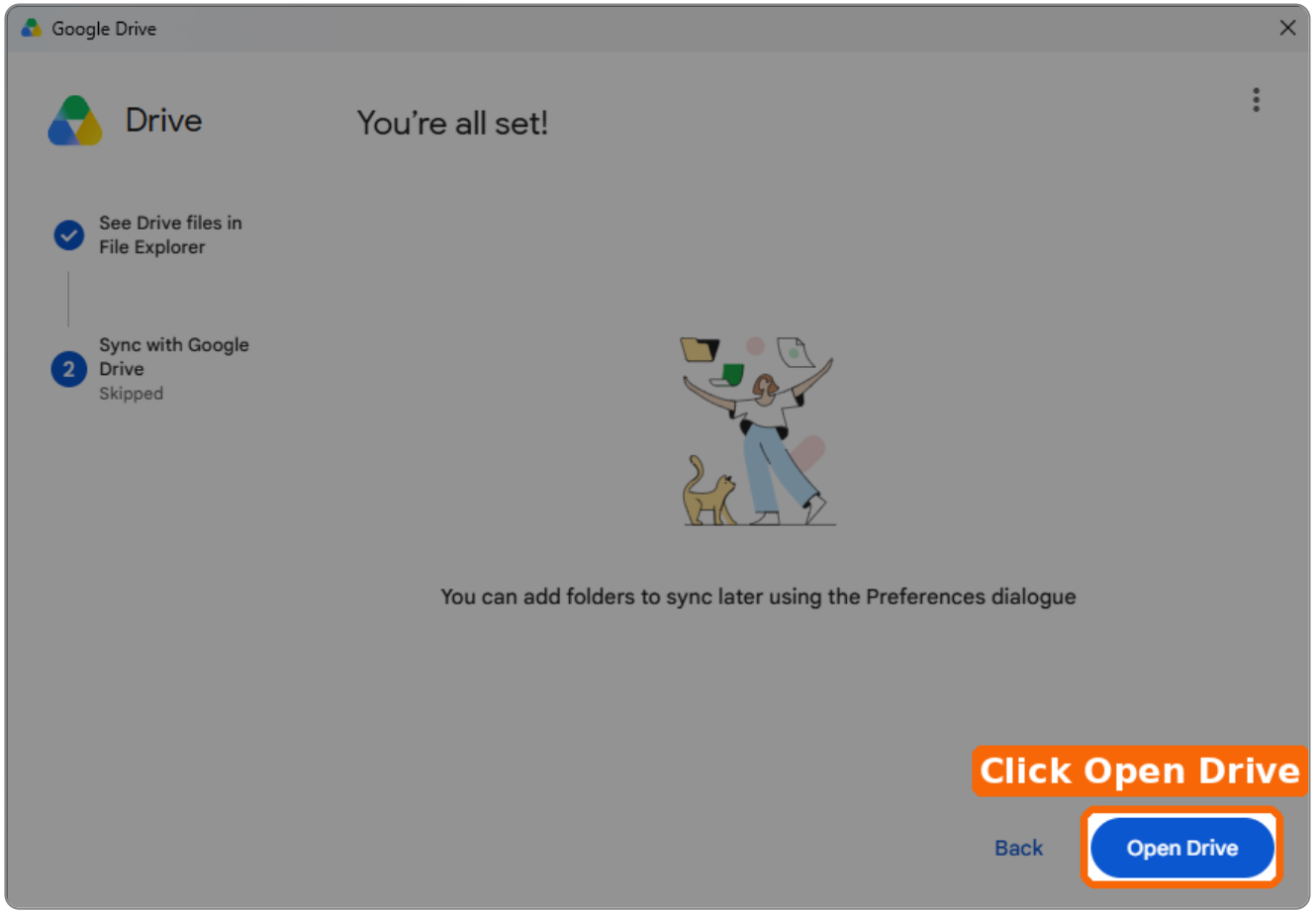
Your work goes straight into My Drive, so you don't need to sync these folders.



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Google Drive › You're all set!

Click **Open Drive**.



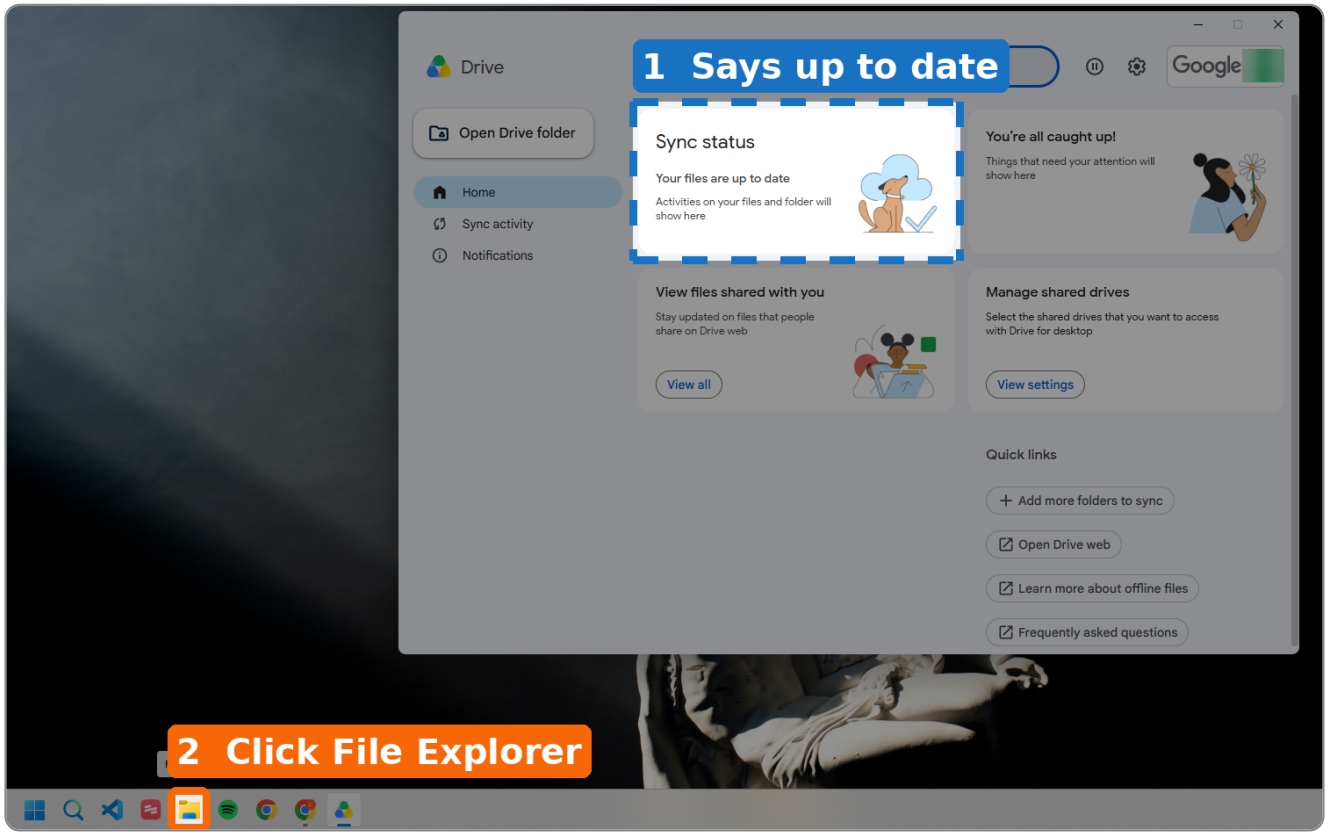
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Google Drive › Home

Under **Sync status**, check it says **Your files are up to date**.

Click **File Explorer** in the taskbar.

You can close this Google Drive window. Google Drive keeps running in the background.

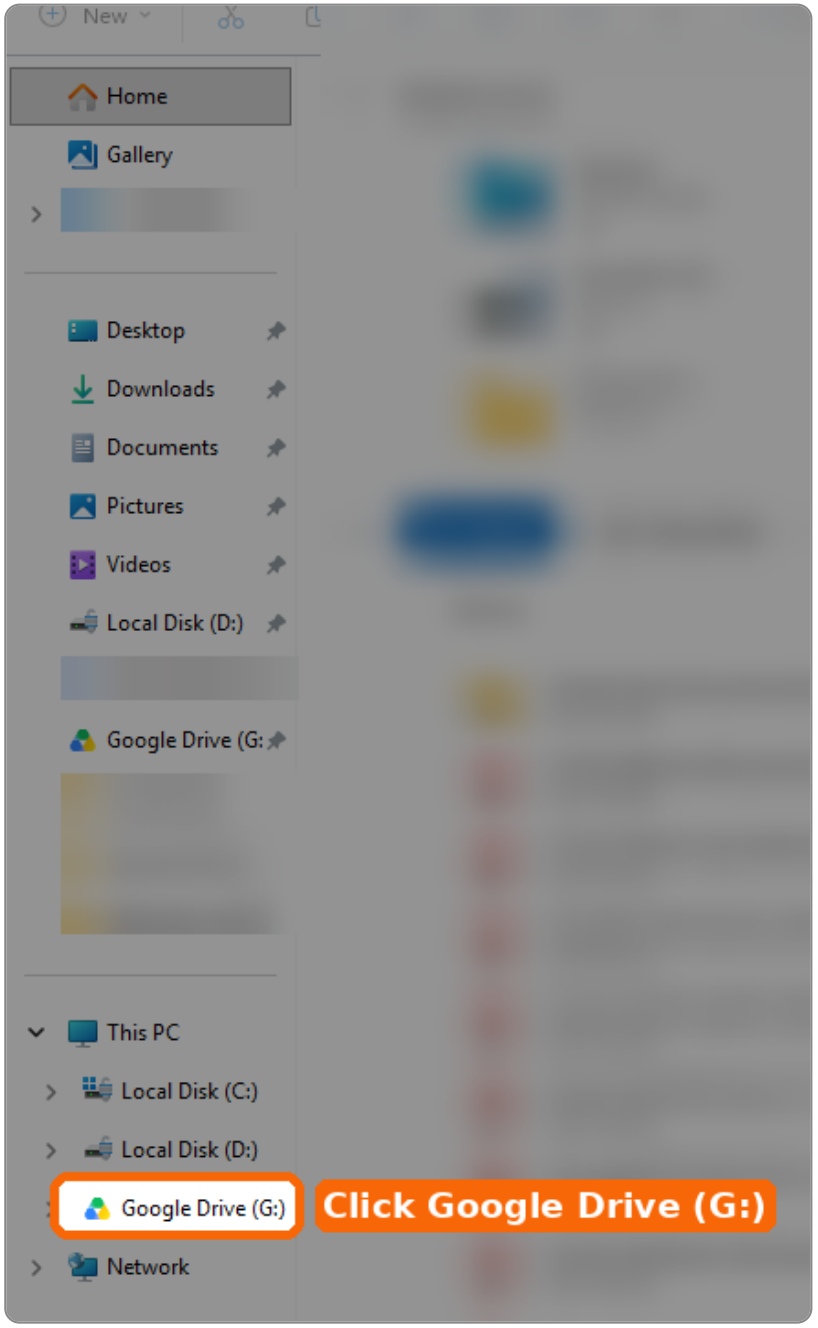


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File Explorer

In the left pane, under **This PC**, click **Google Drive (G:)**.

If something goes wrong
No Google Drive (G:): wait a little, then press F5 to refresh File Explorer.

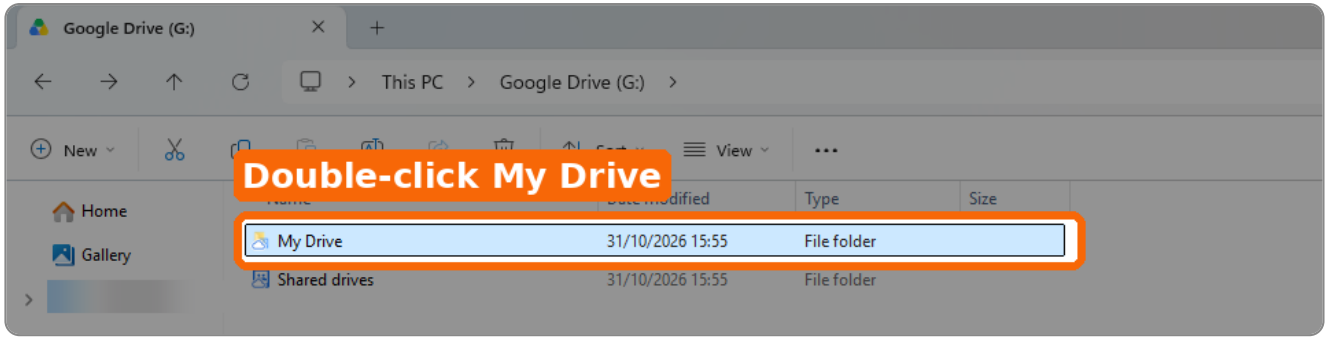


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File Explorer › Google Drive (G:)

Double-click **My Drive**.

> **Check:** you see **My Drive** and **Shared drives**.

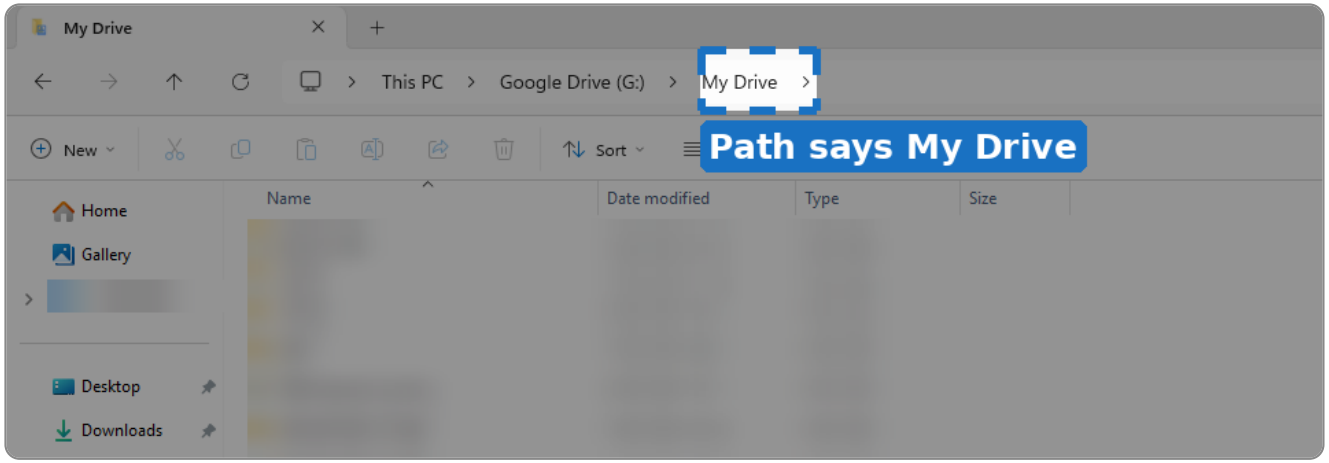


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File Explorer › My Drive

Look at your files and folders.

> **Check:** the path says `Google Drive (G:)` › `My Drive`, and you see the same files and folders as Google Drive in Chrome.



Every lesson
Save your work in `Google Drive (G:)` › `My Drive`, never on the Desktop or in Downloads. Google Drive backs it up, so you can open it on any computer.

Is everything saved to Google Drive?
Click the ^ arrow in the taskbar, then the Google Drive icon. Wait until it says your files are up to date before you log off.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I signed in to Google Drive for desktop with my school account.
- [ ] I can find `Google Drive (G:)` › `My Drive` in File Explorer.
- [ ] I know to save my work in My Drive.

